

# Concrete

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**B**y the early 20th century, concrete buildings were becoming as prevalent as steel structures. From its use in sinuous art nouveau forms, such as Gaudí's Sagrada Família, to more angular structures, such as the Bahá'í House of Worship (opposite, 1912) in Illinois, designed by Louis Bourgeois (1856–1930), concrete could create curving, arched and sculptural designs, a notable example being Mendelsohn's expressionist Einstein Tower.

Le Corbusier was the first architect to make wide use of poured and reinforced concrete, after working in Paris with Auguste Perret (1874–1954), a pioneer in reinforced concrete construction, and later with Behrens. From his early unbuilt designs for Maison Dom-ino (1914–15), to the chapel of Notre Dame du Haut at Ronchamp, France (1954), Le Corbusier was fascinated by concrete's adaptability, and by its sculptural and structural potential for relatively little cost.

Reinforced concrete became a favourite of many modern architects, including Oscar Niemeyer, Paul Rudolph (1918–97), Tadao Ando and Santiago Calatrava.

